

Consistently saving *something*

Rituals and habits are king when it comes to most things around money, because it's the small actions that you take every day that add up to your bigger picture, but they are particularly critical with saving. Saving money can feel like the most positive, nourishing habit if you're doing it well – but it can also feel like an insurmountable mountain to climb if you're not used to it, or a huge amount of pressure if you get a little bit obsessed with stashing as much cash as possible. The amount that you would need to save for a house deposit, or to buy a car outright, or even to fund a big holiday, and the amount of time that it will take you to get there can feel daunting, and cause you to feel despondent, wondering what the point in trying is. But if you can reframe saving as something that you do to look after your financial health, and something that you are growing, it will make forming those habits easier to do.

Despite the fact that many of us think that we can't afford to save, and so we put it off for a future time when we might be earning more or forking out less for things like childcare, for those earning a living wage, there is usually *something* that can be put aside, even if it's just a small amount. If you can create a saving habit for a small, affordable amount each week or month – even if it's £10, to start with – you are telling yourself that saving is a priority for you, and you'll be more likely to consider stashing any spare cash in the future, rather than spending it right away. Seeing that pot of money grow, even